Mark O'Hare

Community Manager | Senior Operations Leader | People, Partnerships & Place-Based Delivery

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PROFILE

Community and operations leader with more than twenty years' experience across the Scottish third sector. I have led teams, managed community-facing services, worked closely with trustee boards, built multi-agency partnerships, and delivered programmes that needed strong operational grip as well as trust on the ground. Local to North Lanarkshire, I bring the practical leadership needed to run a busy community facility well, support staff and volunteers properly, build strong local relationships, and help a centre grow in a financially and socially sustainable way.

KEY STRENGTHS

◆ Community operations	◆ Community engagement and stakeholder relations
◆ People management and team development	◆ Funding contribution and income generation
◆ Board and trustee reporting	◆ Health, safety and compliance management
◆ Multi-agency partnership working	◆ Volunteer recruitment and development
◆ Budget oversight and service sustainability	◆ Digital communications and social media

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager | CERT – Clackmannanshire Economic Regeneration Trust *Jan 2022 – Jul 2024*

Joined as Project Manager and promoted within a year, reporting directly to the Chair and Board.

- Scaled a pilot initiative into the largest integrated health-employability programme in the region, supporting 379 participants annually.
- Led multi-agency partnerships with NHS Forth Valley, local authority partners and third sector organisations.
- Held responsibility for safeguarding, risk governance, compliance, trustee reporting, budgets and staff supervision.
- Contributed to more than £850,000 in continuation funding across three years.

Service Manager | Lifelink *Mar 2020 – Jan 2022*

Promoted from Assistant Manager to Service Manager within a year and became part of a four-person Senior Management Team overseeing a therapeutic workforce of 15 to 100 practitioners.

- Stabilised service delivery through an exceptionally demanding operating period, including full pandemic delivery.
- Strengthened safeguarding frameworks, governance reporting and operational oversight.
- Managed risk registers, compliance requirements and delegated financial responsibilities across service areas.

Director & Founder | Holistic Enterprises Scotland *2000 – 2020*

Founded and led a community-based organisation delivering training, youth development and recruitment services across Scotland.

- Built partnerships with schools, police, social services, councils and community organisations.
- Designed and delivered wellbeing, employability and personal development programmes.
- Secured funding and led paid staff and volunteer teams.

Volunteer Development Adviser | Voluntary Action North Lanarkshire *2010 – 2014*

- Designed and delivered volunteer and employability training programmes.

- Supported governance and safeguarding development across member organisations.
- Represented the third sector within community planning structures.

Community Justice Specialist | WG (Portfolio Role) *2014 – 2019*

- Delivered prison-based employability and mentoring programmes at HM Polmont and other Scottish institutions.
- Coordinated referral pathways and maintained compliance with prison data systems.

Advice & Employability Worker | Citizens Advice Bureau | Routes to Work *2004 – 2010*

Delivered advice, advocacy and employability support to vulnerable individuals across Central Scotland.

ADDITIONAL CURRENT ROLES

Managing Director | Kelloch Recruitment & Training *Jul 2024 – Present*

Founded and continue to run a values-led consultancy alongside full-time employment, supporting third-sector organisations with ethical recruitment, workforce planning and operational redesign.

- Cut average cost-per-hire by 45% through direct sourcing and process redesign
- Designed and launched Talent Direct, a permission-based recruitment platform that puts candidate control at the centre of the hiring process
- Delivered trauma-informed leadership and wellbeing training
- Introduced AI-enabled workflow tools to reduce admin burden and improve reporting

Lead Clinical Logistics Driver | Sciensus *Jul 2024 – Present*

Working in a time-critical healthcare logistics role delivering medication safely and compliantly while supporting day-to-day driver operations.

- Deliver time-critical medication in a regulated healthcare logistics environment, maintaining accuracy, professionalism and patient focus
- Support daily driver operations, route cover and shift coordination to help maintain safe, consistent service delivery
- Carry out vehicle checks, defect reporting and accurate compliance records in line with operational standards
- Provide practical support to colleagues and help resolve issues quickly in a fast-paced, high-pressure setting

Professional Photographer & Media Specialist | Self-employed *2008 – Present*

Award-winning part-time professional photographer delivering commercial, portrait and brand-led creative work alongside senior operational roles.

- Produce high-quality photography and visual content for individuals, brands and organisations, from planning and shoot direction through to final delivery
- Advanced user of Adobe Creative Suite including Photoshop, Lightroom and video editing tools for retouching, compositing, colour work and content production
- Create polished imagery and media assets for web, social, print and promotional use, combining technical precision with strong visual storytelling

DIGITAL & CREATIVE CAPABILITY

Award-winning professional photographer and creative media specialist with advanced Adobe Creative Suite skills, including Photoshop, Lightroom and video editing, plus strong capability in web design, social media management, digital communications and content creation.

QUALIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- SVQ Level 5 Learning & Development (SCQF Level 11)
- SVQ Level 4 Mentoring & Leadership (SCQF Level 10)
- HND Community Arts

- Trauma-Informed Practice Facilitator
- Mental Health First Aid Instructor

Additional CPD and professional development available on request.